



TERRY ECOM

Google Ads Scaling Framework

A Profit-First System for Performance Max

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SECTION 01

Core Philosophy

**Scale based on profit and clean data,
not emotions, hacks, or screenshots.**

This framework is built from real PMAX accounts and real scaling conversations. It provides clear rules for when to scale up, when to hold, and when to scale back — without overcomplication.

SECTION 02

Why PMAX Is the Core Engine

Performance Max is the core engine because it:

FULL INVENTORY

Uses all Google channels: Search, Shopping, YouTube, Display, Discover, Gmail

REAL-TIME OPTIMIZATION

Optimizes bidding, placements, creatives, and audiences automatically

SCALE-READY

Performs best when fed clean conversion data and sufficient budget

For eCommerce and dropshipping, PMAX functions as both a demand-capture and demand-expansion engine. When fundamentals are correct, it outperforms heavily manual structures at scale.

SECTION 03

How to Use This Framework

FOR BEGINNERS	Follow exactly as written
FOR EXPERIENCED	Use this as baseline discipline

RULE: Do not add complexity until you are already profitable.

SECTION 04

Framework Overview

Four Phases → One Goal: Scalable Profit

1	LAUNCH Give PMAX clean inputs <i>Days 1-7</i>
2	STABILIZE Fix economics (AOV & CRO) <i>Days 7-14</i>
3	SCALE Increase budget based on profit <i>Ongoing</i>
4	OPTIMIZE Improve margins after scale <i>Post-scale</i>

Launch (Days 1-7)

One Campaign Only

- 1 PMAX campaign
- Full product feed
- No exclusions
- No segmentation

This concentrates data and accelerates learning.

Full Feed, No Bias

Do not:

- Pick 'best sellers'
- Force hero products
- Over-optimize early

Let PMAX discover demand naturally.

Product Tagging (Non-Negotiable)

From day one, tag products by:

- Product type
- Category

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- Logical groupings

This enables clean exclusions and scaling later without rebuilding feeds.

Hands-Off Learning

- Let PMAX run
- Ignore daily noise
- Avoid resets

If PMAX is not spending, wait 3-4 days and relaunch once only if required.

PHASE 2

Stabilization (Days 7-14)

This phase fixes the business, not the ads.

AOV Comes Before Scaling

AOV RANGE	STATUS
Below \$50	FRAGILE
\$50-\$60	LIMITED
\$60+	SCALABLE
\$70+	IDEAL

Low AOV + higher spend = amplified losses

Increase AOV First

Use:

- Bundles

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- 10-15% upsells
 - Quantity breaks
 - Clear navigation
 - Strong product pages

Do not scale ads to fix bad economics.

CRO Over Ad Tweaks

Improve:

- Trust signals
- Clarity
- Checkout simplicity

Ads amplify problems - they do not solve them.

Scaling (Profit-Based)

Scaling decisions are made using profit and trustworthy data.

Green Days vs Red Days

GREEN DAY	Net profitable after ad spend for that day
RED DAY	Net unprofitable after ad spend for that day

Revenue - ad spend = the decision metric.

ROAS supports context, but profit is the final decision-maker. Use reliable tracking tools like TrackBee to verify data accuracy.

SCALE UP - 2 GREEN DAYS RULE

Scale UP when:

- You have 2 green days in a row
- PMAX is spending normally
- No tracking or site issues exist

Recommended increase: 20-30% per step

Examples: \$120 → \$160 (~33%) | \$160 → \$220 (~37%) | \$220 → \$300+ (~36%)

Scaling is done in clear checkpoints, not tiny daily adjustments.

SCALE BACK - 2 RED DAYS RULE

Scale DOWN when:

- You have 2 red days in a row
- Net profit turns negative after ad spend
- No clear external issue exists

Recommended decrease: 20-30%, or return to last profitable level

This prevents emotional reactions to single bad days while protecting capital.

Optimization (After Scale)

Optimization happens after scale, not before.

Identify Natural Winners

Once scaled:

- Winning products become obvious
- Decisions become data-driven

Then:

- Improve margins
- Negotiate COGS
- Upgrade suppliers

Smart Exclusions (Optional)

Use product tags to:

- Exclude consistent losers
- Create future campaign variants

Never exclude emotionally.

Product Selection Guidelines

Products that scale best:

- Low return risk
- No sizing complexity
- Simple buying decision

Examples: Sunglasses | Watches | Men's fashion basics

Lower returns = safer scaling.

Common Mistakes to Avoid

- Multiple PMAX campaigns too early
- Scaling before AOV is fixed
- Trusting Shopify analytics blindly
- Resetting campaigns frequently
- Scaling without profit discipline

QUICK REFERENCE

Scaling Checklist

BEFORE SCALING

- Tracking verified
- AOV healthy
- PMAX spending consistently

SCALE UP (2 GREEN DAYS)

- Increase budget by +20-30%

SCALE BACK (2 RED DAYS)

- Reduce budget by -20-30%
- Or return to last profitable level

PMAX rewards discipline, confidence, and clean data.

Scale profits, not emotions. Hold when uncertain. Pull back when losses repeat.

This is how real accounts scale.